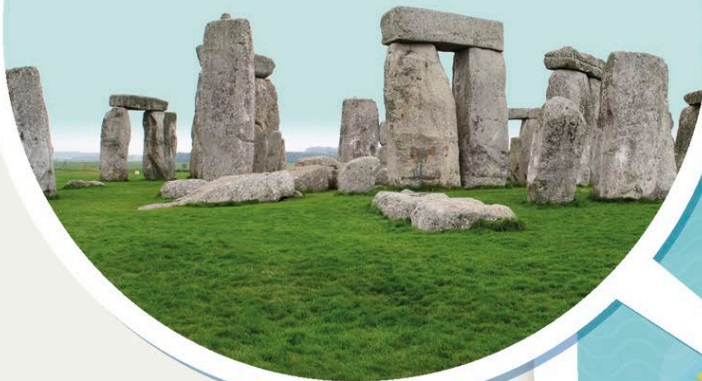


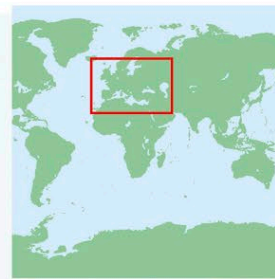
Stonehenge

Farming people worked together to create huge monuments called megaliths, meaning "great stones." Some were tombs to bury the dead. Others, such as Stonehenge in Britain, were places for religious ceremonies.



Settling down

Farming began in Asia and then moved into Europe. People settled down in different places and started a variety of cultures.



Early trade

After people settled down as farmers, they began to make things to trade, such as pots. The most prized objects for trading were polished stone axes, which people started making around 4000 BCE. They were traded across long distances.



Polished flint axes



The Stone Age

The earliest period of our history is called the Stone Age because people used tools made from stone. They hunted wild animals and gathered wild plants. Later, starting around 10,000 BCE, people in East Asia began to plant crops and keep animals. Farming then spread west across Europe.